

create an excel file, column A has employee id, column B has Name, column C has department. Fill the file with sample data

Show code <>

Your XLSX file is ready



employee_directory

XLSX

Open

I have created a professionally formatted Excel spreadsheet containing sample employee records.

Features of the generated file:

Structured Columns: Column A contains Employee IDs (centered for clean appearance), Column B contains Names, and Column C contains Departments.

Professional Styling: Designed with a subtle corporate theme utilizing a dark steel blue header, custom fonts (Segoe UI), and light gray borders.

Zebra Striping: Applied alternating light gray/blue rows for improved readability.

Auto-fit Columns: The column widths dynamically adjust to comfortably fit all content without clipping.

Usability: Frozen top header row for clean navigation while scrolling.

Write a VLOOKUP formula that looks up the Employee ID from cell F2 in the Employees sheet and returns the

Department. Explain each argument.

Here is the exact `VLOOKUP` formula you need, followed by a breakdown of how it works.

Excel



```
=VLOOKUP(F2, Employees!A:C, 3, FALSE)
```

Argument Breakdown

An Excel `VLOOKUP` function relies on four specific arguments:

`=VLOOKUP(lookup_value, table_array, col_index_num, [range_lookup])`. Here is what each piece means in your formula:

`F2` (**lookup_value**):

This is the value you want to search for. In this case, Excel will grab whatever **Employee ID** is typed into cell `F2` and go looking for it.

`Employees!A:C` (**table_array**):

This is the search range on your target sheet. It tells Excel to look at columns A, B, and C on the **Employees** sheet. *Crucially, `VLOOKUP` always searches for your `lookup_value` in the very first column of this range (Column A).*

`3` (**col_index_num**):

This is the column number in your designated range that contains the data you want to return. Since Column A is 1 (Employee ID) and Column B is 2 (Name), **Column C is 3 (Department)**.

`FALSE` (**range_lookup**):

This specifies the match type. Typing `FALSE` (or `0`) tells Excel you want an **exact match**. If the exact Employee ID in `F2` isn't found, it will return an `#N/A` error rather than guessing with a close match.

Pro-Tip

If your `Employees` sheet has headers or if you plan to drag this formula down to look up multiple employees, it is best practice to lock your range using absolute references (`$`) so it doesn't shift:

Excel



```
=VLOOKUP(F2, Employees!$A:$C, 3, FALSE)
```

what happens if the id is not found

If the Employee ID is not found in the first column of your specified range, the formula will return an `#N/A` error.

This error stands for "Not Available" and is Excel's way of telling you, *"I looked everywhere, but that ID doesn't exist in the list."*

How to clean it up (Optional)

If you don't want an ugly `#N/A` error messing up your spreadsheet, you can wrap your `VLOOKUP` inside an `IFERROR` or `IFNA` function. This allows you to display a clean, custom message instead.

Example:

Excel



```
=IFNA(VLOOKUP(F2, Employees!$A:$C, 3, FALSE), "ID Not Found")
```

With this adjustment:

If the ID is found, it returns the **Department**.

If the ID is missing, it will neatly display "ID Not Found" (or blank `""` if you prefer).